Sarath Sadasivan Pillai

Engineering Director · Tech Lead · Distributed Systems

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PROFILE

Engineering leader and hands-on tech lead with 12+ years designing and running distributed backend systems in Go. Today I am Director of Engineering at WellSync, a medtech company, where I lead the team and its technical direction on services that handle sensitive health data, and co-founder and CTO of Message+.

Earlier I drove Exotel's platform-wide migration from PHP/Ruby/Java to Go and led its API team on a 99.999% SLA platform, then built real-time voice infrastructure at MessageBird, a live-streaming backend at Onefootball, and compliance-critical data systems at Shell. I work at staff level: shaping architecture across teams, setting engineering standards, mentoring engineers, and turning reliability goals (delivery guarantees, observability, API design) into decisions that business, legal, and regulatory stakeholders can follow.

SKILLS

Languages	Go (primary, ~10 years), Python, SQL, JavaScript/Svelte, Java, PHP
Systems	Distributed systems, event-driven architecture, REST and gRPC API design, webhooks, delivery guarantees and retries, high-throughput real-time services
Reliability	Observability, monitoring and logging (Grafana, OpenTelemetry), incident review, SLAs, error budgets
Data & tools	PostgreSQL, MySQL, Linux, gRPC, SvelteKit, Claude Code (agentic development)
Domains	Cloud communications / CPaaS (voice, SMS, messaging), real-time media, medtech and health data, regulated systems (GDPR, telecom, audit)
Leadership	Technical direction, mentoring, coding standards and review, working with product, business, and legal stakeholders

EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering · Tech Lead · WellSync — Aug 2024 – Present
Rotterdam / Barendrecht, NL — medtech

- Led development of new revenue-generating services with strong reliability guarantees.
- Improved system observability so production behaviour is easier to detect, investigate, and document.
- Mentored engineers on development and release practices, reducing production problems.
- Improved infrastructure and technical support capabilities.
- Brought Sparrow, my own webhook delivery system, into production use.

Go, Kubernetes, PostgreSQL, gRPC, Kafka, Grafana, Azure

Co-Founder & CTO · Message+ — Dec 2022 – Present
Rotterdam, NL — remote, part-time — multi-channel customer support

- Co-founded the company and own its technical direction.
- Sole backend developer: built the Go backend, including the AI-assisted support component.
- Designed scalable enterprise messaging infrastructure; launched on WhatsApp first, then Instagram.
- Built support-metric tracking (response time, resolution rate).
- Work directly with customers on integration, contracts, and compliance expectations.

Go, PostgreSQL, gRPC, REST, New Relic, Azure

Senior Software Engineer · Shell — Nov 2020 – Aug 2024
Rotterdam, NL

- Built and maintained data-driven systems for sustainability and regulatory reporting, where data quality and timeliness were compliance-critical.
- Worked with business stakeholders on product strategy, internal controls, and audit expectations.
- Designed systems to be easy to monitor, explain, and adjust as regulation changed.

Go, Kubernetes, PostgreSQL, gRPC, Kafka, New Relic, Azure

Senior Software Engineer · MessageBird (Bird) Jun 2019 – Nov 2020

Amsterdam, NL

- Built core real-time call-handling logic in Go: call setup, connection, and completion.
- Kept voice services stable against strict service-level and contractual requirements; improved API availability.
- Introduced clearer monitoring and incident review, reducing downtime. Established shared coding and review practices.
- Worked within telecom regulation, data protection, and cross-border constraints.

Go, PHP, Kubernetes, MySQL, Redis, GCP Pub/Sub, Elasticsearch, GCP

Software Engineer · Onefootball Feb 2019 – Jun 2019

Berlin, DE

- Built the backend for OTT video delivery in the mobile apps, enabling live pay-per-view match streaming under hard latency constraints.

Go, Kubernetes, MySQL, Java, REST, GCP

Technical Lead · Exotel May 2014 – Dec 2018

Bengaluru, IN

- Joined as roughly employee 18; the company scaled to ~200 and became Asia's largest cloud telephony platform.
- Led the migration of the full platform from PHP/Ruby/Java to Go — smaller memory footprint, single-binary deployment, and quick for the team to learn.
- Owned the usage-based billing system: ran the Java version, then rewrote it in Go.
- Led the API team and guided public API and SDK design on a 99.999% SLA platform.
- Led teams scaling core calling and messaging systems for high-volume customers, and delivered Exotel's first mobile app on a short timeline.

Go, PHP, Kubernetes, MySQL, Aerospike, Beanstalk, Elasticsearch, AWS

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Sparrow Go, PostgreSQL, gRPC, SvelteKit

Event-driven webhook delivery with at-least-once guarantees, backoff retries, `Retry-After` handling, idempotency keys, and full observability. In production at WellSync. sarathsp06.github.io/sparrow

TestHooks Go, Svelte · open source

A self-hostable webhook.site replacement: capture, inspect, transform, and forward webhooks in real time from a single binary. testhooks.vercel.app

JanusFS Go, FUSE, Linux · open source

Secret-masking filesystem for AI agents: secrets read as **** with byte length preserved, kernel-enforced on Linux. github.com/sarathsp06/janusfs

Herdr Web Go, SvelteKit, WebSocket · open source

Mobile-first web inbox for the Herdr agent multiplexer, with live terminals and push alerts; one Go binary, with outside contributors. github.com/sarathsp06/herdrweb

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering · TKM College of Engineering · CGPA 8.24/10 2009 – 2013

English (full professional) · Malayalam (native) · Hindi (limited working)

HIGHLIGHTS

- Led the migration of Exotel's entire platform from PHP, Ruby, and Java to Go. Joined as roughly employee 18; the company scaled to ~200.
- Led Exotel's API team on an API-first platform run under a 99.999% SLA. API customers at Exotel and MessageBird included Google and Uber.
- Built Message+ single-handedly as CTO and sole backend developer.
- Author of Sparrow, an event-driven webhook delivery system now in production at WellSync.